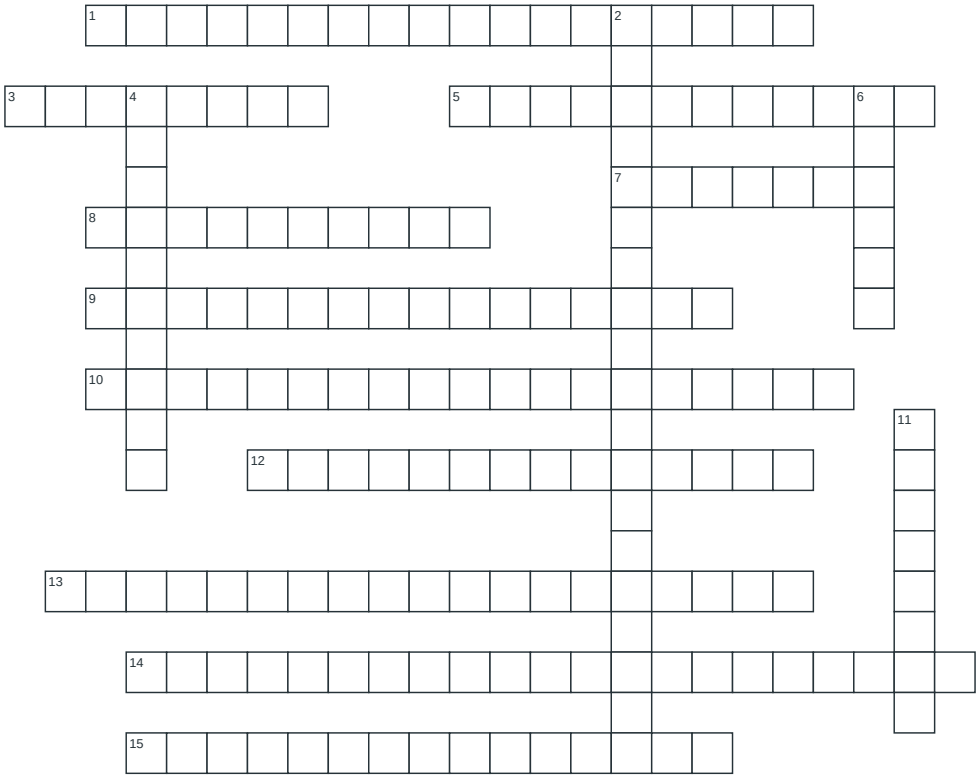
Evolution and Natural Selection Crossword

Medium | 15 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

1. Inherited differences among individuals in a population.
3. Change in DNA that can introduce heritable variation.
5. Random change in allele frequencies, strongest in small populations
7. Relative contribution of an organism's offspring to later generations.
8. Evolutionary process in which populations become separate species
9. Process in which heritable traits affecting reproduction change in frequency
10. A change in inherited population characteristics across generations
12. Shared ancestry inferred from similarities among organisms.

ACROSS (continued)

13. Feature with a similar underlying organization inherited from a common ancestor.
14. Barriers that limit gene exchange between populations.
15. Proportion of a population's gene copies represented by an allele.

DOWN

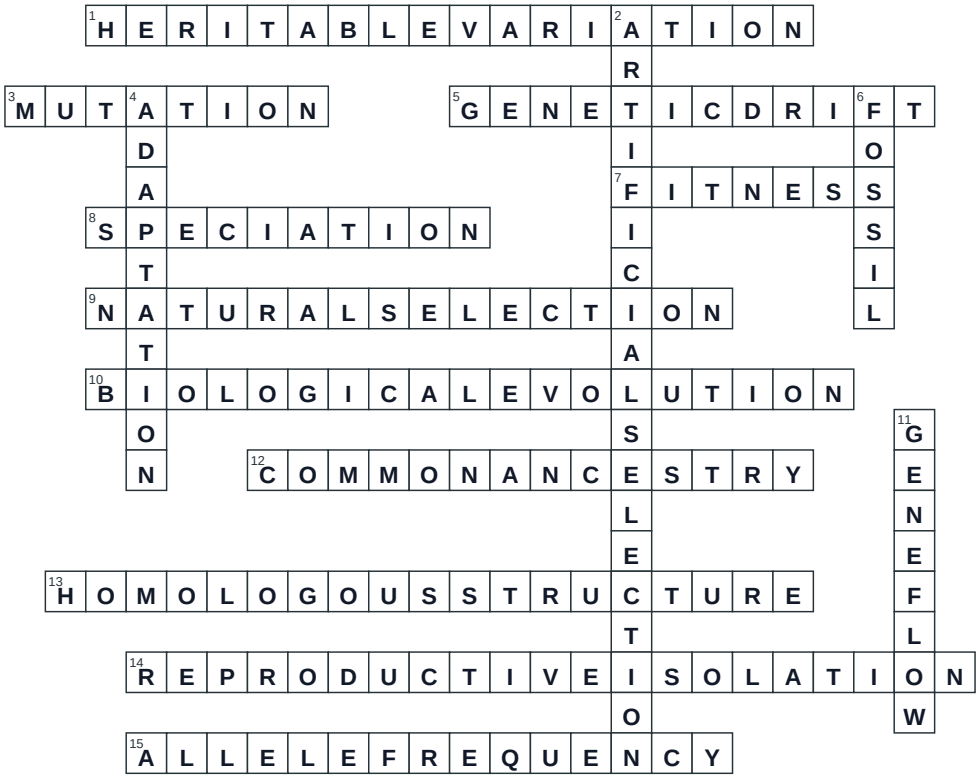
2. Process that involves humans choosing organisms with desired traits to reproduce
4. A heritable feature that improves success in a particular environment
6. Preserved remains or traces of past life
11. Movement of alleles between populations

Evolution and Natural Selection Crossword

Medium | 15 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.



ACROSS

1. Heritable variation
3. Mutation
5. Genetic Drift
7. Fitness
8. Speciation
9. Natural Selection
10. Biological Evolution
12. Common ancestry

ACROSS (continued)

13. Homologous structure
14. Reproductive isolation
15. Allele frequency

DOWN

2. Artificial Selection
4. Adaptation
6. Fossil
11. Gene Flow